

RAND HALASA

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Software engineer who takes AI-powered products, internal tools, and workflow automation from problem definition through to production. Sole engineer owning automation at a 100-client digital agency, building Python and TypeScript systems on top of LLMs and third-party APIs.

EXPERIENCE

Product Engineer · *Search it Local*

Aug 2026 – Present

- Own the company's automation function as its sole engineer, taking internal problems from stakeholder discovery and scoping through architecture, development, deployment, and maintenance across a 100-client operation.
- Shipped a client-facing quiz application used as a lead-generation product, contributing to a 10% increase in monthly recurring revenue.
- Build production LLM-powered internal tools in Python and TypeScript using the Claude API and Claude Code, turning ambiguous requests from SEO and sales teams into deployed workflows.
- Identify and eliminate high-friction manual processes by combining LLMs, REST APIs, browser automation, and internal tooling.

SEO Specialist · *Search it Local*

Apr 2026 – Aug 2026

- Cut a recurring reporting workflow from 5 hours to 20 minutes, eliminating roughly 15 hours of manual analyst work per month.
- Designed and built automated data-retrieval tooling serving 100 client accounts, integrating the Ahrefs, SE Ranking, Google Search Console, and Apify REST APIs.
- Delivered first-page Google rankings through technical, on-page, off-page, and site-speed optimisation.

Software Engineering Intern · *WinBoard*

Aug 2024 – Nov 2024

- Built a real-time computer vision pipeline in Python analysing advertising engagement from live camera feeds, extracting dwell time, sentiment, and demographic signals per viewer with YOLOv8 and FairFace under GDPR-compliant anonymisation.
- Delivered interactive dashboards and configured cloud deployment supporting concurrent video-processing streams.

AI Development Intern · *MobiSoft Mobility*

Nov 2023 – Feb 2024

- Built AI tooling that automated customs-tracking workflows for Middle Eastern government clients, including multilingual semantic search over item descriptions using Apache Solr and Vectara.

Programming Tutor · *Independent*

Feb 2023 – Mar 2026

- Delivered one-on-one Java and Python tutoring to university students, improving average assessment scores by approximately 20%.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Fairness & Bias in AI Medical Chatbots, Honours Thesis · [repo](#)

Feb 2026 – Jun 2026

- Built an end-to-end evaluation pipeline for two deployed AI medical chatbots, collecting 1,546 responses and 22,936 turn-level observations across 2,029 conversations via resilient browser automation.
- Built a multi-turn patient simulator on a locally served Llama 3 model, and benchmarked six ML classifier configurations across TF-IDF and sentence-embedding features at 0.963–0.999 cross-validated macro-F1.

Jordan Language Academy, Freelance · *currently uploading* · [repo](#)

July 2026 – Present

- Rebuilt a 15-year-old static website into a modern production application as the sole developer, owning information architecture, UX, frontend, deployment, and technical SEO, designed for the client to maintain without technical assistance.

ChartChat, LLM Chat Assistant Browser Extension · [repo](#)

Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

- Built a Next.js Chrome extension giving conversational access to live market data through a locally hosted Ollama LLM, integrating the Dexscreener and CoinGecko APIs with Socket.io streaming and Google OAuth.

EDUCATION

University of Sydney, B.E. (Honours), Software Engineering

Aug 2022 – Jun 2026

Honours thesis: Evaluating Fairness and Bias in AI-Powered Medical Chatbots.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, SQL, C

AI / LLM: Claude API, Claude Code, Ollama, Llama 3, LLM evaluation, scikit-learn, PyTorch

Backend / Frontend: FastAPI, Django, Node.js, REST API design & integration, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, React, Next.js, Vue 3, Tailwind

Automation / Infra: Browser automation, Docker, Linux, Jenkins, CI/CD, Git, pytest, JUnit

Search / Data & APIs: Elasticsearch, Apache Solr, Vectara, Ahrefs, SE Ranking, Google Search Console, Apify

Spoken languages: English, Modern Standard Arabic, Shami Arabic (all native), French (intermediate), Mandarin (beginner)